

Senior Design Self Assessment
Luke Myers

Part A - Two Paragraphs: What was your individual contribution to this project? Did you apply and build upon the skills identified in your initial assessment from last Fall? What did you do and how did you do it? What did you learn and what competencies did you build? What were your successes, what were your obstacles?

In our project we worked on creating a full stack web application. For my role, I contributed in many different areas. I came up with the original idea and design of our project. I also contributed to some of the database design, back end endpoint creation and logic, as well as some front end design, mainly working on the data flow between the UI and the API. My main skills were front end development, and I was able to use my skills to assist in the area. I also build on some of my SQL database design skills and backend skills. While these weren't very strong to start, I was able to learn more about them and help with them.

During this project, I helped design and create a SQL database. I did this by brainstorming everything that the application would need, then creating tables with the correct values, primary and secondary keys. I was also able to design API endpoints by thinking about functionality needed, writing SQL queries and determining the best way to return them to the front end. I learned a lot more about backend development, as well as how to host a project. I also learned a lot about middleware, authorization, and tokens. I faced some obstacles when it came to third party data, but had plenty of success in creating a straightforward backend system that completes our needs for the project

Part B – Two Paragraphs: What did your group accomplish? What did you learn about group work? What aspects of teamwork were successful and what aspects of teamwork were not successful? How did your efforts on the project compare to that of your teammates? Do any team members deserve special recognition?

Our group was able to accomplish working together to create a full stack web application with user authentication and interactive abilities. I learned that communication is very important in group work. Making sure that people know their responsibilities and areas to work on was crucial in our project. I also learned that division of work can be done many way. Its not always dividing the group into different technologies (frontend, backend, database), but dividing by domain (third party data, user authorization, data flow etc).

An aspect of teamwork that was successful was our meetings. We would meet once a week, share what we did in the past week, what we planned to work on in the future week, and ask any questions we had for each other. I think one thing that would have made this more successful was a shorter secondary meeting, so we could touch base on progress and bounce more ideas off of each other. I think we should have done a better job with strictly assigning tasks, through tickets. We would just say what we were going to work on, and while we found success with this, I think a more defined system would've made us more efficient. Me and my teammates all did a good job of dividing the effort evenly. No one had to do any extra work compared to another person.